Website Field Study: Lefkoşa Türk Belediyesi

Site: https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
Organisation: Lefkoşa Türk Belediyesi (Nicosia Turkish Municipality)
Student: Tuğberk Ata – 2403060010
Audit date: 2026-11-08, from 17:13 EET (follow-up checks on 2026-11-09 and 2026-11-10)
Browser: Arc (Chromium-based) on macOS, with Chrome DevTools

Part A: Under the hood

A1 – HTTPS and redirects

Typing `http://` ended on `https://`; the 307 shown in DevTools came from the browser upgrading the connection itself. The certificate is valid (WE1, Google Trust Services, expires 28 Dec 2026), so visitors get an encrypted connection with no warnings – important for a site with payment and complaint forms [A1].

A2 – URL structure

URL	HTTPS	Short & readable	Lowercase	Hyphens not underscores	Few query params
https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/baskan	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass (single word)	Pass
https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/sehir-fotograflari	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/haberler/metaverse-nft-ve-yapay-zeka-sinemayla-bulusuyor	Pass	Pass (long but readable)	Pass	Pass	Pass
https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/etkinlik-takvimi	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/sehrin-tarihi	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass

All five URLs are short, lowercase Turkish words joined by hyphens, with no IDs or parameters, and Turkish letters are converted (`fotograflari`), so addresses stay readable and easy to share. News slugs copy the whole headline and can get long [A2].

A3 – One request, closely

Method: GET · Status: 200 OK · Content-Type: text/html; charset=utf-8 · Requests: 118 · Total size: 4.7 MB transferred (11.4 MB of resources), finished in 3.45 s [A3-request-summary] · Fetch/XHR example: `widget-settings` (fetch, started by the Tawk.to live-chat script, visible in B3-offline-navigation)

The HTML is small (about 13 kB), but the page loads a 3.2 MB background video – about two-thirds of the total – plus many third-party scripts (Google Analytics, Meta Pixel, Tawk.to chat). Cloudflare does not cache the HTML (`Cf-Cache-Status: DYNAMIC`), so every visit waits about 0.7 s for the municipality's server. The site also answers on both `lefkosabelediyesi.org` and `www.` without redirecting one to the other [A3].

A4 – A page that does not exist

Status code: **404** (a second made-up address, `/532523`, also returned GET 404 for the document [A4-status-404]) · Visitor sees: large "404", "Maalesef aradığınız sayfayı bulamadık." ("Sorry, we couldn't find the page you were looking for."), buttons "Ana Sayfaya Dön" (back to home) and "Online İşlemlere Dön" (back to online services).
The page is friendly and branded, with a plain-Turkish apology and two ways out. The server returns a real 404 status, not a normal 200, so it is a proper 404 rather than a soft 404 and search engines will not index dead links. It offers no search box or contact link [A4].

A5 – Caching

Main document `Cache-Control`: `no-cache, private` – the browser must check with the server before reusing it, and Cloudflare may not store it.
Image `Cache-Control` (/storage/3752/FOTO-1-%2810%29.jpeg): `max-age=14400` (Age: 4909, served from memory cache) – the photo can be reused for 4 hours without asking again.
Fresh HTML and reusable images is a sensible split, but 4 hours is short for news photos that never change; Lighthouse flagged the same ("Use efficient cache lifetimes") [A5].

A6 – Where the page is built

Server-rendered, with browser enhancements. The raw source already contains all real content – menu, search box, news cards, Online İşlemler cards and footer. JavaScript only adds extras: the accessibility widget, the chat iframes, carousel copies and the search results, which `search.js` fills in. Because the content is in the HTML, text appears before scripts finish (B1) and search engines can read it [A6].

A7 – SEO basics

Item	Found?	Value / note
`<title>`	Yes	"Lefkoşa Türk Belediyesi" – organisation name only, no description of the page
Meta description	Yes (weak)	"Lefkoşa Türk Belediyesi Resmi Web Sitesi" ("official website") – generic, mentions no services
Canonical link	**No**	Missing; both `https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/` and `https://www.lefkosabelediyesi.org/` return the page [A3]
`lang` attribute	Yes	`<html lang="tr">`
Number of `<h1>`	**0**	No `<h1>` on the home page; the main heading "Nasıl yardımcı olabiliriz?" is an `<h2>`
`rel="sponsored"` / `rel="ugc"`	Not applicable	No adverts or user comments on the page
Other	–	`og:type` declared twice; `<meta name="keywords" content="">` is empty; Open Graph title, description and image are present

The title and description only say "Lefkoşa Türk Belediyesi – official website", telling searchers nothing about services. There is no `<h1>` (the main heading is an `<h2>`) and no canonical link, although A3 showed the site answering on two addresses. Lighthouse still scored SEO 100, so a perfect automated score does not mean nothing is missing [A7].

Part B: The experience

B1 – Loading state (Slow 3G)

Throttling: Slow 4G – this browser's throttling presets are Fast 4G, Slow 4G and 3G, so Slow 4G was used; a slower 3G connection would make every stage below last longer.
Stage 1: completely blank white page – no logo, no spinner, no text [B1-loading-1].
Stage 2: layout and all text visible on a plain dark background (no video yet); every icon shows as an empty square – search icon, language-menu arrow, carousel arrows, "Tüm haberler için" chevron – because the icon font (around-icons) is still downloading [B1-loading-2].
Stage 3: background video and icon font loaded; page looks complete [B1-loading-3].
The first seconds are a blank white page, even though the site's code contains a loading spinner, so a resident on weak signal may think the site is broken. Text then arrives before decoration (good, see A6), but icons appear as empty boxes until their font loads. The finished look waits on a purely decorative 3.2 MB video [B1].

B2 – Empty state

Search term: "zzzzq" (home-page search box, filter "Genel") · Exact wording shown: "Maalesef hiç sonuç bulamadık." ("Unfortunately, we found no results.")
Results appear instantly in a dropdown under the box, without a page reload; the five filter buttons (Genel, Haberler, Etkinlikler, Tarihi ve Turistik Yerler, Meclis Kararları) stay visible. No spelling suggestion, no link to Online İşlemler, Alo 185 or the contact page.
The message is clear, polite and instant, matching the tone of the 404 page. But it offers no next step – no link to Alo 185, Online İşlemler or İletişim, which the site already has [B2].

B3 – Error state (Offline)

Navigation while offline (clicked "Online İşlemler" → /online): the request failed and the browser replaced the site with its own error page (dinosaur, "Press space to play", ERR_INTERNET_DISCONNECTED). Nothing from the municipality is shown – no logo, no message, no retry button [B3-offline-navigation].
Search while offline (typed "çöp" without reloading): the `search` request failed and the dropdown showed "Arama sonuçları getirilirken bir sorun oluştu." ("A problem occurred while fetching the search results."), with no retry button [B3-offline-search].
Offline, clicking a link replaces the site with the browser's own error page, with no message or retry from the municipality. That is normal for most sites, so it is a missed opportunity rather than a serious fault. The in-page search handles it better: it shows its own error message, clearly different from "no results", so the visitor is not misled – though it neither says the connection is lost nor offers a retry [B3].

B4 – Form validation

Form tested: "Lefkoşalılar Söylüyor" contact form on https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/iletisim · Fields left empty: all five (Adınız, Soyadınız, Telefon Numaranız, E-posta Adresiniz, message) · "Gönder" pressed; the form was not sent.
Errors appear inline on every field at once: red border plus a red ⊘ icon inside each box. **No error text** – nothing says what is wrong or what format is expected (e.g. for phone or e-mail). The Cloudflare check above the button shows "Success!". Required fields are marked with a red asterisk in advance. Typed input is kept: with "Test" in Adınız and the other fields empty, pressing Gönder left "Test" in place and marked that field green with a ✓, while the empty fields turned red [B4-input-kept].
The form blocks incomplete submissions and marks required fields in advance, but errors are shown only by colour and an icon, with no text explaining what is wrong. Colour-blind and screen-reader users get no usable feedback

[B4].

B5 – Labels

Field	Visible label?	Clicking label focuses field?	Placeholder only?
Adınız	Yes	**No**	No
Soyadınız	Yes	**No**	No
Telefon Numaranız	Yes	**No**	No
E-posta Adresiniz	Yes	**No**	No
Soru görüş ve önerilerinizi bekliyoruz. (message)	Yes	**No**	No

Why clicking the label does nothing: each field is not inside its `<label>`, and the label has no `for` attribute pointing to the field (the message `<textarea name="questions_comments_suggestions">` has no `id` at all). The label text is only visually above the field, so the browser does not connect them [B5].

Sighted users will not notice, but a screen reader announces each field only as "edit text", so blind users cannot tell the fields apart [B5].

B6 – Keyboard only

Task: move from the top of the home page to the Online İşlemler cards using only the keyboard · Keys used: Tab, Enter · Focus visible? **No** – Tab does move focus (Console `document.activeElement` returned the "İşyeri Veri Güncelleme Formu" card link), but that card shows no outline, border or colour change; it looks exactly like the cards around it. The only hint is the browser's own link preview at the bottom of the window, so it is very hard to tell where focus is [B6-keyboard] · Order logical? Could not be judged by eye, because focus is invisible · Traps? None met on the way to the cards · Skip link? **No** – none appears on the first Tab press · Task completed? Yes, but only confirmed through the Console, not by looking at the page

Keyboard users must guess where they are, and there is no skip link. This contradicts the site's own accessibility widget, which claims WCAG 2.1 compliance; one CSS rule for `:focus-visible` would fix it [B6].

B7 – Automated audit (Lighthouse Accessibility)

Page	Score	Top 3 issues
Home (https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/, 8:53:17 PM)	**86** (Performance 81, Best Practices 96, SEO 100)	1. Form elements do not have associated labels · 2. Links do not have a discernible name · (only these two audits failed in the Names and Labels section; "Image elements do not have [alt] attributes that are redundant text" is informational only). A second run scored 87, so the score varies by about one point between runs.
İletişim (https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/iletisim, 3:28:11 PM)	**83** (Performance 89, Best Practices 73, SEO 100)	1. Form elements do not have associated labels · 2. `<frame>` or `<iframe>` elements do not have a title · 3. Links do not have a discernible name (a colour-contrast failure is also listed) [B7-lighthouse-inner-a11y]

Also seen while inspecting: the large footer logo (`ltb-tum-renkler.png`, "Lefkoşa Nicosia – tüm renklerin kardeşçe yaşadığı şehir") has `alt=""`, so its slogan is hidden from screen-reader users [B7-footer-logo-alt]. Icons render as garbled characters (e.g. `î¤Œ`) while the icon font loads [B7-lighthouse-inner].

Scores in the mid-80s look fine, but the main failures on both pages are the same problems found by hand in B5 and B8, and it cannot detect the invisible keyboard focus from B6 at all [B7].

B8 – Link and button text

Current text	Where	Better text
Image only, `alt="Logo"` (19 links)	Home page, partner/project logo strip (orchestra, theatre, Paylaşım Mutfağı, marathon, etc.)	Name each project in the alt text, e.g. "Lefkoşa Belediye Orkestrası" / "Paylaşım Mutfağı"
"Previous slide" / "Next slide" (icon-only buttons)	Home page, news carousel arrows	Turkish labels matching the page language: "Önceki haber" / "Sonraki haber"
Image only, `alt="ai-logo"`	Footer, designer credit link	"Ai Web Solutions"
"Tüm haberler için ›"	Home page, under the news carousel	"Tüm haberleri gör" (a complete action, not a sentence fragment)
"Soru ve Cevaplar →" / "Kent Rehberi →"	Home page, FAQ and city-guide cards	Acceptable; could be more specific, e.g. "Sıkça sorulan soruları oku" / "Kent rehberi haritasını aç"

Visible link text is mostly clear; the problem is image- and icon-only links, which screen readers announce as "Logo" nineteen times [B8].

Part C: Recommendations

What works well

1. **Clean, readable Turkish URLs.** Addresses like `/sehrin-tarihi` are lowercase Turkish words with hyphens and no codes, so residents can read and share them [A2].
2. **A friendly, branded 404 page.** Broken links show a plain-Turkish apology with two ways out, and the server returns a real 404 status, so search engines are not misled [A4].

Top three problems

Why this order: ranked by how badly each problem stops a resident from getting something done – problem 1 can block contact entirely, problem 2 slows everyone down, problem 3 mainly affects search and screen readers.

#	Problem	Evidence	Who it affects	Fix in plain words	Effort	Impact
1	The contact form cannot be used properly by keyboard or screen reader: labels are not linked, errors are colour-only, keyboard focus is invisible.	B4, B5, B6, B7	Blind and partially sighted residents, people who cannot use a mouse, colour-blind users	Link each label to its field, add short error text under wrong fields, show a visible frame around the selected element	Low	High
2	The home page is slow and data-heavy: blank at first, icons missing, then a 3.2 MB decorative video.	A3, B1, B7	Every visitor, especially on mobile data or weak signal	Replace the video with a compressed photo, show the existing loading spinner, cache images longer	Medium	Medium
3	The page structure is incomplete: no <h1>, no canonical link while two addresses work, logo links named only "Logo".	A3, A7, B7, B8	Screen-reader users and residents searching on Google	Make the main question an <h1>, redirect to one address and declare it canonical, name each logo	Low	Medium

Appendix A: Evidence log

ID	File	What it shows	Time and date	Page address
A1	evidence/A1-https-address.png	Address bar ending on https://	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://www.lefkosabelediyesi.org/
A1	evidence/A1-certificate.png	Certificate for lefkosabelediyesi.org, issued by WE1 (root GTS Root R4), expires 28 Dec 2026, shown as valid	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://www.lefkosabelediyesi.org/
A2	– (URL table in the report)	Five page URLs scored against the five URL rules	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	Five URLs listed in A2
A3	evidence/A3-request-summary.png	Network summary for one clean home-page load: 118 requests, 4.7 MB transferred, 11.4 MB resources, finish 3.45 s; bg.mp4 about 3.2 MB	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
A3	evidence/A3-network.png	Main document request: GET, 200 OK, Content-Type text/html; charset=utf-8, Server cloudflare, Cache-Control no-cache, private	Sun 8 Nov 2026, 20:28 EET (server Date header 18:28:30 GMT)	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
A4	evidence/A4-status-404.png	Network panel: made-up address /532523 returns GET 404 (document)	9 Nov 2026	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/532523
A4	evidence/A4-missing-page.png	Made-up page /no-such-page-123: branded 404 page with two navigation buttons; request highlighted red in Network panel	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/no-such-page-123
A5	evidence/A5-document-cache-control.png	Main document Cache-Control: no-cache, private	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
A5	evidence/A5-asset-cache-control.png	Image Cache-Control: max-age=14400, Age 4909, 200 OK (from memory cache)	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/storage/3752/FOTO-1-%2810%29.jpeg
A6	evidence/A6-elements.png (raw source compared via View Source)	View-source vs Elements panel for the home page (Elements shows JS-added accessibility wrapper, chat widget, Swiper slide copies)	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
A7	– (values in the A7 table, read from the page source)	<head> meta tags (title, description, no canonical) and no <h1> element	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
B1	evidence/B1-	Home page loading on Slow 4G:	8 Nov 2026,	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/

	loading-1.png, evidence/B1-loading-2.png, evidence/B1-loading-3.png	blank → text with missing icons → complete with video	17:13–20:53 EET (three screenshots a few seconds apart)	
B2	evidence/B2-empty-search.png	Home-page search for "zzzzq": message "Maalesef hiç sonuç bulamadık." with filter buttons, no next step offered	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
B3	evidence/B3-offline-search.png	Offline search for "çöp": failed `search` request and message "Arama sonuçları getirilirken bir sorun oluştu."	10 Nov 2026	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
B3	evidence/B3-offline-navigation.png	Offline navigation to /online: browser's own ERR_INTERNET_DISCONNECTED page, request "online" failed in Network panel	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/online
B4	evidence/B4-input-kept.png	Contact form with "Test" in Adınız only after pressing Gönder: text kept, field green with ✓, other fields red	10 Nov 2026	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/iletisim
B4	evidence/B4-form-errors.png	Contact form "Lefkoşalılar Söylüyor" submitted empty: red borders and ⊘ icons on all five fields, no error text	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/iletisim
B5	evidence/B5-labels.png	Contact form with visible labels; Elements panel shows the message `<textarea>` has a name but no `id`, next to a separate `<label>`	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/iletisim
B6	evidence/B6-keyboard.png	Keyboard focus on the "İşyeri Veri Güncelleme Formu" card (confirmed by `document.activeElement` in Console) with no visible focus indicator on the page	8 Nov 2026, 17:13–20:53 EET	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
B7	evidence/B7-lighthouse-home.png	Lighthouse on home page: Performance 81, Accessibility 86, Best Practices 96, SEO 100	Sun 8 Nov 2026, 20:53	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
B7	evidence/B7-lighthouse-home-issues.png	Accessibility 87 (second home-page run): failed audits "Form elements do not have associated labels" and "Links do not have a discernible name"	9 Nov 2026	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
B7	evidence/B7-lighthouse-inner.png	Lighthouse on İletişim page: Performance 89, Accessibility 83, Best Practices 73, SEO 100 (Performance insights shown)	Mon 9 Nov 2026, 15:28	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/iletisim
B7	evidence/B7-lighthouse-inner-a11y.png	İletişim Accessibility 83: unlabelled form elements, iframes without a title, links without a name, colour contrast	10 Nov 2026, 10:01	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/iletisim
B7	evidence/B7-footer-logo-alt.png	Footer logo `ltb-tum-renkler.png` with empty `alt` in Elements	9 Nov 2026	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/
B8	evidence/B8-carousel-buttons.png	Carousel buttons with English aria-labels ("Next slide"); partner-logo `alt="Logo"` values come from the page source	9 Nov 2026	https://lefkosabelediyesi.org/